10.8 Taylor and Maclaurin Series

We have seen how geometric series can be used to generate a power series for functions such as $f(x) = 1/(1 - x)$ or $g(x) = 3/(x - 2)$. Now we expand our capability to represent a function with a power series. This section shows how functions that are infinitely differentiable generate power series called *Taylor series*. In many cases, these series provide useful polynomial approximations of the original functions. Because approximation by polynomials is extremely useful to both mathematicians and scientists, Taylor series are an important application of the theory of infinite series.

Series Representations

We know from Theorem 21 that within its interval of convergence I the sum of a power series is a continuous function with derivatives of all orders. But what about the other way around? If a function $f(x)$ has derivatives of all orders on an interval, can it be expressed as a power series on at least part of that interval? And if it can, what are its coefficients?

We can answer the last question readily if we assume that $f(x)$ is the sum of a power series about $x = a$,

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x - a)^n \\ &= a_0 + a_1(x - a) + a_2(x - a)^2 + \cdots + a_n(x - a)^n + \cdots \end{aligned}$$

with a positive radius of convergence. By repeated term-by-term differentiation within the interval of convergence I, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} f'(x) &= a_1 + 2a_2(x - a) + 3a_3(x - a)^2 + \cdots + na_n(x - a)^{n-1} + \cdots, \\ f''(x) &= 1 \cdot 2a_2 + 2 \cdot 3a_3(x - a) + 3 \cdot 4a_4(x - a)^2 + \cdots, \\ f'''(x) &= 1 \cdot 2 \cdot 3a_3 + 2 \cdot 3 \cdot 4a_4(x - a) + 3 \cdot 4 \cdot 5a_5(x - a)^2 + \cdots, \end{aligned}$$

with the nth derivative being

$$f^{(n)}(x) = n!a_n + \text{a sum of terms with } (x - a) \text{ as a factor.}$$

Since these equations all hold at $x = a$, we have

$$f'(a) = a_1, \qquad f''(a) = 1 \cdot 2a_2, \qquad f'''(a) = 1 \cdot 2 \cdot 3a_3,$$

and, in general,

$$f^{(n)}(a) = n!a_n.$$

These formulas reveal a pattern in the coefficients of any power series $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x-a)^n$ that converges to the values of f on I ("represents f on I"). If there *is* such a series (still an open question), then there is only one such series, and its nth coefficient is

$$a_n = \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}.$$

If f has a series representation, then the series must be

$$f(x) = f(a) + f'(a)(x-a) + \frac{f''(a)}{2!}(x-a)^2 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x-a)^n + \cdots. \tag{1}$$

But if we start with an arbitrary function f that is infinitely differentiable on an interval containing $x = a$ and use it to generate the series in Equation (1), does the series converge to $f(x)$ at each x in the interval of convergence? The answer is maybe—for some functions it will but for other functions it will not (as we will see in Example 4).

5 THEOREM If f has a power series representation (expansion) at a, that is, if

$$f(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} c_n(x-a)^n \qquad |x-a| < R$$

then its coefficients are given by the formula

$$c_n = \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}$$

6
$$f(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x-a)^n$$
$$= f(a) + \frac{f'(a)}{1!}(x-a) + \frac{f''(a)}{2!}(x-a)^2 + \frac{f'''(a)}{3!}(x-a)^3 + \cdots$$

The series in Equation 6 is called the **Taylor series of the function f at a** (or **about a** or **centered at a**). For the special case $a = 0$ the Taylor series becomes

7
$$f(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(n)}(0)}{n!}x^n = f(0) + \frac{f'(0)}{1!}x + \frac{f''(0)}{2!}x^2 + \cdots$$

This case arises frequently enough that it is given the special name **Maclaurin series**.

Taylor and Maclaurin Series

The series on the right-hand side of Equation (1) is the most important and useful series we will study in this chapter.

DEFINITIONS Let f be a function with derivatives of all orders throughout some interval containing a as an interior point. Then the **Taylor series generated by f at $x = a$** is

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(k)}(a)}{k!}(x-a)^k = f(a) + f'(a)(x-a) + \frac{f''(a)}{2!}(x-a)^2 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x-a)^n + \cdots.$$

The **Maclaurin series of f** is the Taylor series generated by f at $x = 0$, or

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(k)}(0)}{k!}x^k = f(0) + f'(0)x + \frac{f''(0)}{2!}x^2 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(0)}{n!}x^n + \cdots.$$

The Maclaurin series generated by f is often just called the Taylor series of f.

EXAMPLE 1 Find the Taylor series generated by $f(x) = 1/x$ at $a = 2$. Where, if anywhere, does the series converge to $1/x$?

EXAMPLE 1 Find the Maclaurin series of the function $f(x) = e^x$ and its radius of convergence.

SOLUTION If $f(x) = e^x$, then $f^{(n)}(x) = e^x$, so $f^{(n)}(0) = e^0 = 1$ for all n. Therefore the Taylor series for f at 0 (that is, the Maclaurin series) is

Taylor Polynomials

The linearization of a differentiable function f at a point a is the polynomial of degree one given by

$$P_1(x) = f(a) + f'(a)(x - a).$$

In Section 3.9 we used this linearization to approximate $f(x)$ at values of x near a. If f has derivatives of higher order at a, then it has higher-order polynomial approximations as well, one for each available derivative. These polynomials are called the Taylor polynomials of f.

DEFINITION Let f be a function with derivatives of order k for $k = 1, 2, \ldots, N$ in some interval containing a as an interior point. Then for any integer n from 0 through N, the **Taylor polynomial of order n** generated by f at $x = a$ is the polynomial

$$P_n(x) = f(a) + f'(a)(x - a) + \frac{f''(a)}{2!}(x - a)^2 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(k)}(a)}{k!}(x - a)^k + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x - a)^n.$$

EXAMPLE 2 Find the Taylor series and the Taylor polynomials generated by $f(x) = e^x$ at $x = 0$.

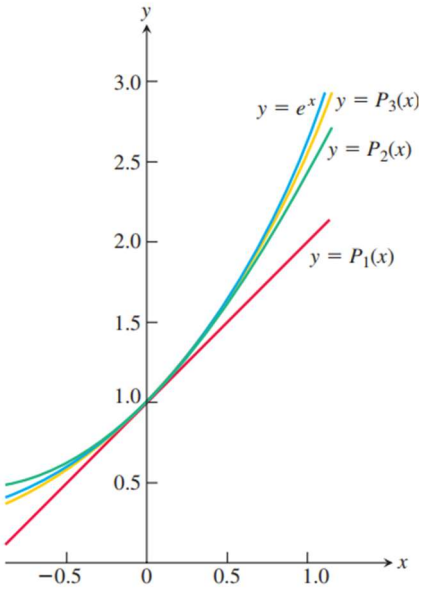


FIGURE 10.22 The graph of $f(x) = e^x$ and its Taylor polynomials

$P_1(x) = 1 + x$

$P_2(x) = 1 + x + (x^2/2!)$

$P_3(x) = 1 + x + (x^2/2!) + (x^3/3!).$

Notice the very close agreement near the center $x = 0$ (Example 2).

EXAMPLE 3 Find the Taylor series and Taylor polynomials generated by $f(x) = \cos x$ at $x = 0$.

Solution The cosine and its derivatives are

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= \cos x, & f'(x) &= -\sin x, \\ f''(x) &= -\cos x, & f^{(3)}(x) &= \sin x, \\ &\vdots & &\vdots \\ f^{(2n)}(x) &= (-1)^n \cos x, & f^{(2n+1)}(x) &= (-1)^{n+1} \sin x. \end{aligned}$$

At $x = 0$, the cosines are 1 and the sines are 0, so

$$f^{(2n)}(0) = (-1)^n, \qquad f^{(2n+1)}(0) = 0.$$

The Taylor series generated by f at 0 is

$$\begin{aligned} f(0) + f'(0)x + \frac{f''(0)}{2!}x^2 + \frac{f'''(0)}{3!}x^3 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(0)}{n!}x^n + \cdots \\ = 1 + 0 \cdot x - \frac{x^2}{2!} + 0 \cdot x^3 + \frac{x^4}{4!} + \cdots + (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n}}{(2n)!} + \cdots \\ = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k x^{2k}}{(2k)!}. \end{aligned}$$

EXERCISES 10.8

Finding Taylor Polynomials

In Exercises 1–10, find the Taylor polynomials of orders 0, 1, 2, and 3 generated by f at a.

1. $f(x) = e^{2x}, \quad a = 0$
2. $f(x) = \sin x, \quad a = 0$
3. $f(x) = \ln x, \quad a = 1$
4. $f(x) = \ln(1 + x), \quad a = 0$
5. $f(x) = 1/x, \quad a = 2$
6. $f(x) = 1/(x + 2), \quad a = 0$
7. $f(x) = \sin x, \quad a = \pi/4$
8. $f(x) = \tan x, \quad a = \pi/4$
9. $f(x) = \sqrt{x}, \quad a = 4$
10. $f(x) = \sqrt{1 - x}, \quad a = 0$

Finding Taylor Series at $x = 0$ (Maclaurin Series)

Find the Maclaurin series for the functions in Exercises 11–24.

11. e^{-x}
12. xe^x
13. $\dfrac{1}{1 + x}$
14. $\dfrac{2 + x}{1 - x}$
15. $\sin 3x$
16. $\sin \dfrac{x}{2}$
17. $7 \cos(-x)$
18. $5 \cos \pi x$
19. $\cosh x = \dfrac{e^x + e^{-x}}{2}$
20. $\sinh x = \dfrac{e^x - e^{-x}}{2}$
21. $x^4 - 2x^3 - 5x + 4$
22. $\dfrac{x^2}{x + 1}$
23. $x \sin x$
24. $(x + 1) \ln(x + 1)$
28. $f(x) = 3x^5 - x^4 + 2x^3 + x^2 - 2, \quad a = -1$
29. $f(x) = 1/x^2, \quad a = 1$
30. $f(x) = 1/(1 - x)^3, \quad a = 0$
31. $f(x) = e^x, \quad a = 2$
32. $f(x) = 2^x, \quad a = 1$
33. $f(x) = \cos(2x + (\pi/2)), \quad a = \pi/4$
34. $f(x) = \sqrt{x + 1}, \quad a = 0$

In Exercises 35–38, find the first three nonzero terms of the Maclaurin series for each function and the values of x for which the series converges absolutely.

35. $f(x) = \cos x - (2/(1 - x))$
36. $f(x) = (1 - x + x^2)e^x$
37. $f(x) = (\sin x) \ln(1 + x)$
38. $f(x) = x \sin^2 x$
39. $f(x) = x^4 e^{x^2}$
40. $f(x) = \dfrac{x^3}{1 + 2x}$

Theory and Examples

41. Use the Taylor series generated by e^x at $x = a$ to show that

$$e^x = e^a\left[1 + (x - a) + \frac{(x - a)^2}{} + \cdots\right]$$

10.9 Convergence of Taylor Series

In the last section we asked when a Taylor series for a function can be expected to converge to the function that generates it. The finite-order Taylor polynomials that approximate the Taylor series provide estimates for the generating function. In order for these estimates to be useful, we need a way to control the possible errors we may encounter when approximating a function with its finite-order Taylor polynomials. How do we bound such possible errors? We answer the question in this section with the following theorem.

THEOREM 23—Taylor's Theorem

If f and its first n derivatives $f', f'', \ldots, f^{(n)}$ are continuous on the closed interval between a and b, and $f^{(n)}$ is differentiable on the open interval between a and b, then there exists a number c between a and b such that

$$f(b) = f(a) + f'(a)(b-a) + \frac{f''(a)}{2!}(b-a)^2 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(b-a)^n + \frac{f^{(n+1)}(c)}{(n+1)!}(b-a)^{n+1}.$$

Taylor's Formula

If f has derivatives of all orders in an open interval I containing a, then for each positive integer n and for each x in I,

$$f(x) = f(a) + f'(a)(x-a) + \frac{f''(a)}{2!}(x-a)^2 + \cdots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x-a)^n + R_n(x), \tag{1}$$

where

$$R_n(x) = \frac{f^{(n+1)}(c)}{(n+1)!}(x-a)^{n+1} \qquad \text{for some } c \text{ between } a \text{ and } x. \tag{2}$$

$$\frac{1}{1-x} = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} x^n = 1 + x + x^2 + x^3 + \cdots \qquad R = 1$$

$$e^x = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^n}{n!} = 1 + \frac{x}{1!} + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \cdots \qquad R = \infty$$

$$\sin x = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n+1}}{(2n+1)!} = x - \frac{x^3}{3!} + \frac{x^5}{5!} - \frac{x^7}{7!} + \cdots \qquad R = \infty$$

$$\cos x = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n}}{(2n)!} = 1 - \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^4}{4!} - \frac{x^6}{6!} + \cdots \qquad R = \infty$$

$$\tan^{-1} x = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n+1}}{2n+1} = x - \frac{x^3}{3} + \frac{x^5}{5} - \frac{x^7}{7} + \cdots \qquad R = 1$$

EXERCISES 10.9

Finding Taylor Series

Use substitution (as in Example 4) to find the Taylor series at $x = 0$ of the functions in Exercises 1–12.

1. e^{-5x} **2.** $e^{-x/2}$ **3.** $5 \sin(-x)$

4. $\sin\left(\frac{\pi x}{2}\right)$ **5.** $\cos 5x^2$ **6.** $\cos\left(x^{2/3}/\sqrt{2}\right)$

7. $\ln(1 + x^2)$ **8.** $\tan^{-1}(3x^4)$ **9.** $\dfrac{1}{1 + \frac{3}{4}x^3}$

10. $\dfrac{1}{2 - x}$ **11.** $\ln(3 + 6x)$ **12.** $e^{-x^2 + \ln 5}$

Use power series operations to find the Taylor series at $x = 0$ for the functions in Exercises 13–30.

13. xe^x **14.** $x^2 \sin x$ **15.** $\dfrac{x^2}{2} - 1 + \cos x$

16. $\sin x - x + \dfrac{x^3}{3!}$ **17.** $x \cos \pi x$ **18.** $x^2 \cos(x^2)$

19. $\cos^2 x$ (*Hint:* $\cos^2 x = (1 + \cos 2x)/2$.)

20. $\sin^2 x$ **21.** $\dfrac{x^2}{1 - 2x}$ **22.** $x \ln(1 + 2x)$

23. $\dfrac{1}{(1 - x)^2}$ **24.** $\dfrac{2}{(1 - x)^3}$ **25.** $x \tan^{-1} x^2$

26. $\sin x \cdot \cos x$ **27.** $e^x + \dfrac{1}{1 + x}$ **28.** $\cos x - \sin x$

29. $\dfrac{x}{3} \ln(1 + x^2)$ **30.** $\ln(1 + x) - \ln(1 - x)$

When we state Taylor's theorem this way, it says that for each $x \in I$,

$$f(x) = P_n(x) + R_n(x).$$

The function $R_n(x)$ is determined by the value of the $(n + 1)$st derivative $f^{(n+1)}$ at a point c that depends on both a and x, and that lies somewhere between them. For any value of n we want, the equation gives both a polynomial approximation of f of that order and a formula for the error involved in using that approximation over the interval I.

Equation (1) is called **Taylor's formula**. The function $R_n(x)$ is called the **remainder of order *n*** or the **error term** for the approximation of f by $P_n(x)$ over I.

If $R_n(x) \to 0$ as $n \to \infty$ for all $x \in I$, we say that the Taylor series generated by f at $x = a$ **converges** to f on I, and we write

$$f(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(k)}(a)}{k!}(x - a)^k.$$

Estimating the Remainder

It is often possible to estimate $R_n(x)$ as we did in Example 1. This method of estimation is so convenient that we state it as a theorem for future reference.

THEOREM 24—The Remainder Estimation Theorem

If there is a positive constant M such that $|f^{(n+1)}(t)| \le M$ for all t between x and a, inclusive, then the remainder term $R_n(x)$ in Taylor's Theorem satisfies the inequality

$$|R_n(x)| \le M\frac{|x - a|^{n+1}}{(n + 1)!}.$$

If this inequality holds for every n and the other conditions of Taylor's Theorem are satisfied by f, then the series converges to $f(x)$.

Using Taylor Series

Since every Taylor series is a power series, the operations of adding, subtracting, and multiplying Taylor series are all valid on the intersection of their intervals of convergence.

EXAMPLE 4 Using known series, find the first few terms of the Taylor series for the given function by using power series operations.

(a) $\frac{1}{3}(2x + x\cos x)$ **(b)** $e^x \cos x$

THEOREM 16—The Alternating Series Estimation Theorem
If the alternating series $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty}(-1)^{n+1}u_n$ satisfies the three conditions of Theorem 15, then for $n \geq N$,

$$s_n = u_1 - u_2 + \cdots + (-1)^{n+1}u_n$$

approximates the sum L of the series with an error whose absolute value is less than u_{n+1}, the absolute value of the first unused term. Furthermore, the sum L lies between any two successive partial sums s_n and s_{n+1}, and the remainder, $L - s_n$, has the same sign as the first unused term.

We leave the verification of the sign of the remainder for Exercise 87.

EXAMPLE 3 We try Theorem 16 on a series whose sum we know:

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty}(-1)^n\frac{1}{2^n} = 1 - \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4} - \frac{1}{8} + \frac{1}{16} - \frac{1}{32} + \frac{1}{64} - \frac{1}{128} + \frac{1}{256} - \cdots.$$

The theorem says that if we truncate the series after the eighth term, we throw away a total that is positive and less than $1/256$. The sum of the first eight terms is $s_8 = 0.6640625$ and the sum of the first nine terms is $s_9 = 0.66796875$. The sum of the geometric series is

$$\frac{1}{1 - (-1/2)} = \frac{1}{3/2} = \frac{2}{3},$$

and we note that $0.6640625 < (2/3) < 0.66796875$. The difference, $(2/3) - 0.6640625 = 0.0026041666\ldots$, is positive and is less than $(1/256) = 0.00390625$. ■

EXAMPLE 5 For what values of x can we replace $\sin x$ by $x - (x^3/3!)$ and obtain an error whose magnitude is no greater than 3×10^{-4}?

DEFINITION

For any real number θ, $e^{i\theta} = \cos\theta + i\sin\theta$. (4)

Equation (4), called **Euler's identity**, enables us to define e^{a+bi} to be $e^a \cdot e^{bi}$ for any complex number $a + bi$. So

$$e^{a+ib} = e^a(\cos b + i \sin b).$$

One consequence of this identity is the equation

$$e^{i\pi} = -1.$$

When written in the form $e^{i\pi} + 1 = 0$, this equation combines five of the most important constants in mathematics.

Miscellaneous

7. **(a)**Given the power series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (-1)^k \frac{(x-2)^k}{2^k(k+1)^{\frac{3}{4}}}$ find the radius and interval of convergence.

(9) *Find all real numbers x for which the power series*

$$\sum_{n=1}^{+\infty} \frac{x^n}{2n-1} = x + \frac{x^2}{3} + \frac{x^3}{5} + \frac{x^4}{7} + \cdots + \frac{x^n}{2n-1} + \cdots$$

is convergent. [Don't forget the endpoints of the interval of convergence.]

(b) Write down the sixth Taylor polynomials about x=0 for the function $f(x) = \sin^2 x$.

[15 pts] a) Find the radius of convergence, the interval of convergence and absolute convergence of the power series $\sum_{n=3}^{\infty}(-1)^n \frac{(2x+1)^n \ln n}{n\, 7^n}$.

[10 pts] b) Use geometric series to find the Taylor series of $f(x) = \frac{1}{3x+4}$ around $x = -1$. Then, use term

[25 pts] Find the radius of convergence, the interval of convergence, and the interval of absolute convergence of the power series $\sum_{n=5}^{\infty} \frac{(2x-7)^n}{n-4}$

(2) **[25p]** For which values of x does the series $\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n (2x+3)^n}{n \ln n}$

(i) converge absolutely?
(ii) converge conditionally?
(iii) diverge?

[12p] **a)** For which values of x does the series $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(x-5)^n}{n^2}$

i) converge absolutely ? **ii)** converge conditionally ? **iii)** converge ?

[13p] **b)** Let $f(x) = xe^x$.

i) Find the n-th order derivative of $f(x)$. $(f^{(n)}(x) = ?)$
ii) Find the Maclaurin series generated by $f(x)$.
iii) Find the interval of convergence of the Maclaurin series generated by $f(x)$.